Famous Europeans

A list of famous Europeans.

Founding Fathers of the European Union

Konrad Adenauer (1876-1967) Adenauer was West Germany's first chancellor after the Second World War. He was keen to forge closer ties with the USA, France and the rest of Europe. He played a key role in the re-integration of Germany in European affairs, which became a critical backbone of the European community.

Willy Brandt (1913-1992) German politician and statesman. Opposed to Hitler, he fled to Norway. After WWII he became Mayor of Berlin playing a vital role to defuse tensions during the Cold War stand-off with the Soviet Union. Became Chancellor of Germany in 1979, made a famous gesture of reconciliation to victims of Nazi Germany at Warsaw. He sought rapprochement with the East and creating a stronger, united Europe.

Walter Hallstein (1901 – 1982) German diplomat and statesman. He was one of the key

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architects of the European Coal and Steel Community – the forerunner of the EEC. He became the first President of the Commission of the European Economic Community from 1958-67. He was a keen federalist and worked towards the integration of Europe.

Jean Monnet (1888 – 1979) French statesman who played a key role in founding the Coal and Steel pact which helped improve relations between France and Germany. In 1955, Monnet founded the Action Committee for the United States of Europe. His successfully lobbying led to the creation of the EEC 'Common Market' in 1958.

Joseph Bech (1887-1973) Bech was a politician from Luxembourg who is considered a founding father of the EU. With other Benelux countries, he helped convene the Messina conference of 1955, which led to the Treaty of Rome and creation of the European Economic Community in 1958.

Johan Willem Beyen (1897-1976) Beyen was a Dutch politician who helped create an impetus for the creation of the EEC. After the breakdown of talks over a common European foreign policy, Beyen was one of the Benelux countries who helped push for horizontal integration and the revival of the idea about European integration.

Charles de Gaulle (1890 – 1970) Under de Gaulle's presidency, France became a member of the EEC, and de Gaulle spoke enthusiastically about a European federation. However, de Gaulle partly saw the EEC as an antidote to the US, and de Gaulle blocked the